

SOLICITATION/CONTRACT/ORDER FOR COMMERCIAL PRODUCTS AND COMMERCIAL SERVICES

NOTE: OFFEROR TO COMPLETE BLOCKS 12, 17, 23, 24, AND 30.

1. REQUISITION NUMBER		PAGE 1 OF 37	
2. CONTRACT NUMBER	3. AWARD/EFFECTIVE DATE	4. ORDER NUMBER	5. SOLICITATION NUMBER 140G0126Q0118
			6. SOLICITATION ISSUE DATE 04/24/2026
7. FOR SOLICITATION INFORMATION CALL:		a. NAME Terrence Hardy	
		b. TELEPHONE NUMBER (No collect calls) 7036487377	
9. ISSUED BY USGS NATIONAL ACQUISITION BRANCH 205 NATIONAL CENTER 12201 SUNRISE VALLEY DRIVE RESTON VA 20192		10. THIS ACQUISITION IS ☐ UNRESTRICTED OR ☒ SET ASIDE: 100.00% FOR: ☒ SMALL BUSINESS ☐ WOMEN-OWNED SMALL BUSINESS (WOSB) NORTH AMERICAN INDUSTRY CLASSIFICATION STANDARD (NAICS): ☐ HUBZONE SMALL BUSINESS ☐ ECONOMICALLY DISADVANTAGED 541690 ☐ SERVICE-DISABLED VETERAN-OWNED SMALL BUSINESS (SDVOSB) ☐ 8(A) \$19 SIZE STANDARD:	
11. DELIVERY FOR FREE ON BOARD (FOB) DESTINATION UNLESS BLOCK IS MARKED ☒ SEE SCHEDULE	12. DISCOUNT TERMS		
13a. THIS CONTRACT IS A RATED ORDER UNDER THE DEFENSE PRIORITIES AND ALLOCATIONS SYSTEM - DPAS (15 CFR 700) ☐		13b. RATING	
14. METHOD OF SOLICITATION ☒ REQUEST FOR QUOTE (RFQ) ☐ INVITATION FOR BID (IFB) ☐ REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)		15. DELIVER TO See Schedule	
16. ADMINISTERED BY See Schedule		17a. CONTRACTOR/ OFFEROR CODE FACILITY CODE	
18a. PAYMENT WILL BE MADE BY CODE		18b. SUBMIT INVOICES TO ADDRESS SHOWN IN BLOCK 18a UNLESS BLOCK BELOW IS CHECKED ☐ SEE ADDENDUM	
17b. CHECK IF REMITTANCE IS DIFFERENT AND PUT SUCH ADDRESS IN OFFER ☐		19. ITEM NO.	
20. SCHEDULE OF SUPPLIES/SERVICES ADMINISTERED BY: USGS NATIONAL ACQUISITION BRANCH 205 NATIONAL CENTER 12201 SUNRISE VALLEY DRIVE RESTON VA 20192 US DELIVER TO: Continued... (Use Reverse and/or Attach Additional Sheets as Necessary)		21. QUANTITY	
22. UNIT		23. UNIT PRICE	
24. AMOUNT		25. ACCOUNTING AND APPROPRIATION DATA	
26. TOTAL AWARD AMOUNT (For Government Use Only)		27a. SOLICITATION INCORPORATES BY REFERENCE (FEDERAL ACQUISITION REGULATION) FAR 52.212-1, 52.212-4. ADDENDA FAR 52.212-3 AND 52.212-5 ARE ATTACHED. ☐ ARE ☐ ARE NOT ATTACHED	
27b. CONTRACT/PURCHASE ORDER INCORPORATES BY REFERENCE FAR 52.212-4. FAR 52.212-5 IS ATTACHED. ADDENDA ☐ ARE ☐ ARE NOT ATTACHED		28. CONTRACTOR IS REQUIRED TO SIGN THIS DOCUMENT AND RETURN COPIES TO ISSUING OFFICE. CONTRACTOR AGREES TO FURNISH AND DELIVER ALL ITEMS SET FORTH OR OTHERWISE IDENTIFIED ABOVE AND ON ANY ADDITIONAL SHEETS SUBJECT TO THE TERMS AND CONDITIONS SPECIFIED	
29. AWARD OF CONTRACT: REFERENCE OFFER DATED. YOUR OFFER ON SOLICITATION (BLOCK 5), INCLUDING ANY ADDITIONS OR CHANGES WHICH ARE SET FORTH HEREIN, IS ACCEPTED AS TO ITEMS:		30a. SIGNATURE OF OFFEROR/CONTRACTOR	
31a. UNITED STATES OF AMERICA (SIGNATURE OF CONTRACTING OFFICER)		30b. NAME AND TITLE OF SIGNER (Type or print)	
31b. NAME OF CONTRACTING OFFICER (Type or print) Terrence Hardy		30c. DATE SIGNED	
31c. DATE SIGNED		30d. DATE SIGNED	

19. ITEM NO.	20. SCHEDULE OF SUPPLIES/SERVICES	21. QUANTITY	22. UNIT	23. UNIT PRICE	24. AMOUNT
00001	USGS NCCWSC 12201 Sunrise Valley Drive MS 400 Reston VA 20192 US Delivery: 06/30/2027 Base Period. Firm Fixed Price (FFP). Provide Non-personal services to perform task identified in the attached SOW. Product/Service Code: R499 Product/Service Description: SUPPORT-PROFESSIONAL: OTHER Period of Performance: 07/01/2026 to 06/30/2027	1	LS		
01001	Option Period 1. Firm Fixed Price (FFP). Provide Non-personal services to perform task identified in the attached SOW. (Option Line Item) Anticipated Exercise Date 06/30/2027 Product/Service Code: R499 Product/Service Description: SUPPORT-PROFESSIONAL: OTHER Period of Performance: 07/01/2027 to 06/30/2028	1	LS		

32a. QUANTITY IN COLUMN 21 HAS BEEN

☐ RECEIVED☐ INSPECTED☐ ACCEPTED, AND CONFORMS TO THE CONTRACT, EXCEPT AS NOTED: _____

32b. SIGNATURE OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE

32c. DATE

32d. PRINTED NAME AND TITLE OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE

32e. MAILING ADDRESS OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE

32f. TELEPHONE NUMBER OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE

32g. EMAIL OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE

33. SHIP NUMBER

34. VOUCHER NUMBER

35. AMOUNT VERIFIED
CORRECT FOR

36. PAYMENT

37. CHECK NUMBER

☐ PARTIAL ☐ FINAL☐ COMPLETE ☐ PARTIAL ☐ FINAL

STOCK RECORD (S/R)

40. PAID BY

38. S/R ACCOUNT NUMBER

39. S/R VOUCHER NUMBER

41a. I CERTIFY THIS ACCOUNT IS CORRECT AND PROPER FOR PAYMENT

41b. SIGNATURE AND TITLE OF CERTIFYING OFFICER

41c. DATE

42a. RECEIVED BY (Print)

42b. RECEIVED AT (Location)

42c. DATE RECEIVED (MM/DD/YYYY)

42d. TOTAL CONTAINERS

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

This is a combined synopsis/solicitation for commercial items prepared in accordance with the format in Subpart 12.6, as supplemented with additional information included in this notice. This announcement constitutes the only solicitation; quotations are being requested and a written solicitation will not be issued. FAR clauses and provisions enclosed within this RFQ are those in effect through Federal Acquisition Circular (FAC) 2026-01 and the Revolutionary FAR Overhaul updates currently enacted by DOI Deviations and are available in full text through Internet access at [http:// www.acquisition.gov/far/](http://www.acquisition.gov/far/).

- FAR 52.212-1, Instructions to Offerors—Commercial, applies to this acquisition and addenda are included in Section L.
- Evaluation procedures are included in Section M.
- Offerors include a completed copy of the provision at 52.212-3, Offeror Representations and Certifications—Commercial Items, with its offer.
- FAR 52.212-4, Contract Terms and Conditions—Commercial Items, applies to this acquisition and addenda are included in Section I.

SECTION B – SUPPLIES OR SERVICES AND PRICES/COSTS

1.1 GENERAL

United States Geological Survey is issuing this Request for Quotation (RFQ) for services in accordance with the Statement of Work titled “External Review Support Services”, in Section C.

Offerors will not be reimbursed for any costs incurred in developing their submission in response to this RFQ.

1.2 ANTICIPATED AWARD TYPE

The Government anticipates an award of a Firm-Fixed-Price (FFP) Purchase Order as a result of this RFQ.

SET ASIDE: Total Small Business Set Aside

1.3 NORTH AMERICAN INDUSTRY CLASSIFICATION SYSTEM (NAICS) CODE

NAICS Code: 541690 Other Scientific and Technical Consulting Services, and the Small Business Size Standard is \$19,000,000.

1.4 PERIOD OF PERFORMANCE

- Period of Performance:** 12 month base period and one (1) twelve month option period.
External reviews should be generally scheduled on or around the third annual anniversary of the host agreement.
- Place of Performance:** Activities under this cooperative agreement will take place by telephone, email, and at the locations of the Midwest CASC or in a virtual meeting space.

(END OF SECTION B)

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

SECTION C -- DESCRIPTIONS AND SPECIFICATIONS – STATEMENT OF WORK

Department of the Interior U.S. Geological Survey National Climate Adaptation Science Center

External Review of the U.S. Geological Survey Midwest Climate Adaptation Science Center

Introduction: The external review of U.S. Geological Survey (USGS) Regional Climate Adaptation Science Centers (RCASC) is an integral component of the evaluation program developed and adopted by the CASC Network¹. This practice was established to gain information about the activities and outcomes emerging from each RCASC, improve their effectiveness, and/or inform decisions about their future development and administration. The first cycle of external reviews (formerly known as 5-year reviews) of RCASCs was conducted in 2016-2018 (<https://www.usgs.gov/land-resources/climate-adaptation-science-centers/about/program-evaluation>). The reports from the second cycle can be found here: [Program Evaluation | U.S. Geological Survey \(usgs.gov\)](#).

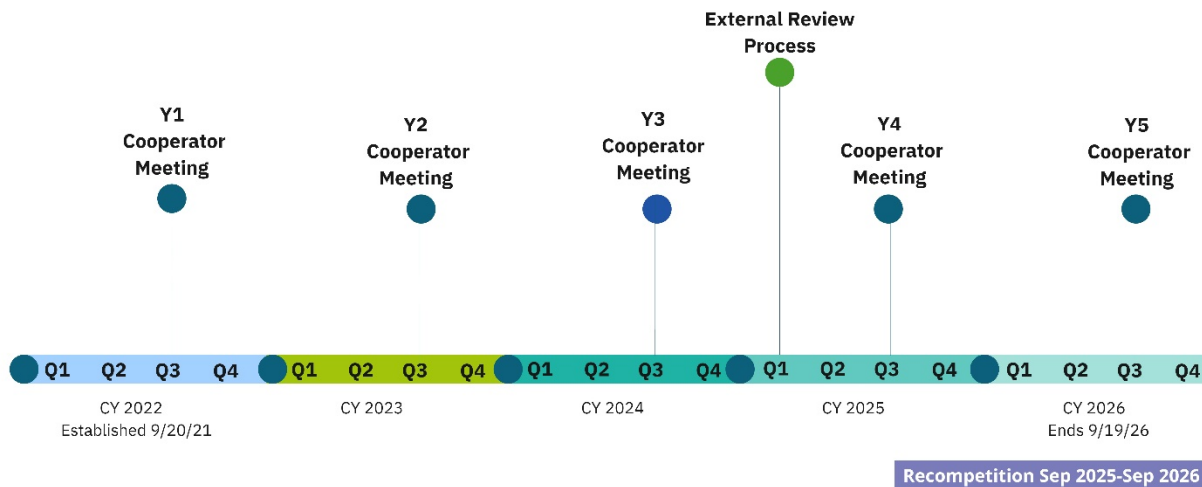
Background: The CASC Network was established in 2008 to develop scientific information — specifically, science focused on climate impacts, adaptation and resilience of plants, fish, wildlife, and their habitats — in response to evolving environmental conditions in every state in the nation. These scientific products and services support natural and cultural resource managers, primarily at federal, state, and tribal resource management entities, as they address adaptation to climate change. Additional information about the NCASC/RCASC enterprise may be found at <https://www.usgs.gov/casc>

Each RCASC is configured as a Federal-Academic partnership containing both a federal USGS-staffed component and a parallel university-based component located in their respective region. The host-universities (and associated consortia of academic institutions) were selected through a competitive request for proposal process and funded through a 5-year cooperative agreement (hereafter referred to as “host agreement”) awarded by the USGS. The periods of performance (PoP) for current Midwest CASC host agreements is September 20, 2021 – September 19, 2026. An additional year is expected to be added to this PoP.

¹ The current configuration of the CASC Network involves a central node – the National Climate Adaptation Science Center (NCASC), a unit at USGS headquarters in Reston, VA – that manages nine RCASCs that serve as regional hubs.

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

MW CASC External Review Timeline



The Midwest CASC must have a new host agreement in place by the end of the final year in the current host agreement. This will be awarded by the USGS through a re-competition process that starts approximately 14 months prior to the expiration of the currently active host agreement.

Prudent fiscal and program management of the RCASC enterprise requires review and evaluation of the host-universities' scientific activities and execution of administrative obligations under their host agreements, as well as identification of areas in need of improvement or adjustment for subsequent agreements. As such, the NCASC, will coordinate an external review of structural and operational aspects of all CASC host-universities' (and associated academic consortium) performance under their host agreements. The purpose of this external review is to:

1. Evaluate the effectiveness of each regional host-university and associated academic consortium in meeting the goals established under their current host agreement,
2. Assess the contribution by each host-university and associated academic consortium with respect to scientific achievements on climate impacts and vulnerability science; collaborative efforts with stakeholders to develop adaptation products applicable to priority regional decision-making; education and training of early career professionals; and outreach and communication services,
3. Evaluate the competencies, efficiencies, challenges, and deficiencies of each host-university in managing the administrative requirements and terms and conditions of the corresponding host agreement,
4. Aid the NCASC in developing improved elements to be considered in the re-competition of the next university hosting agreements.

NCASC seeks a manager/group to conduct the structural and operational evaluation component of these external reviews for the Midwest USGS Climate Adaptation Science Centers in 2025.

While NCASC, with guidance from the former Advisory Committee on Climate Change and Natural Resource Science, has developed guidance on CASC evaluation criteria and measures, the external review manager will have reasonable latitude to structure the review process as they best see fit. The external review manager will

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

work collaboratively with USGS on all aspects of this evaluation. The process for the Midwest CASC should mirror the process that was followed for the other eight regional CASCs.

Requirements: The award recipient will contribute to design, improve, and manage a MW CASC external review process, to include the following:

- a. Provide input and suggest modifications to existing RCASC external review criteria and metrics.
- b. Assemble an Expert Review Team (ERT) team of 3-4 non-CASC affiliated professionals familiar with the CASC Network functioning and activities (from a master list of eligible members compiled by NCASC); a federal senior staff member from the CASC network, but not associated with the RCASC under review; and one support person, to evaluate the operational and scientific/programmatic realities of each host agreement, highlighting accomplishments of the science program managed by host-universities and associated consortium, as well as flagging the competencies, efficiencies, challenges, and deficiencies of each host-university in managing the administrative requirements and terms and conditions of the corresponding host agreement.
- c. Plan for and conduct a site visit to the Midwest CASCs under review. This includes: 1) coordinating site (virtual or in person) visit dates with personnel from the MW CASC under review and NCASC, 2) working with MW CASC personnel on scheduling interviews in advance of the site visit, if necessary, 3) managing travel logistics (airline, lodging, and local transportation arrangements) for ERT members to visit the Midwest CASC host-university.
- d. Conduct required preparation work before visiting the Midwest CASC, record-keeping and management of documents related to the Midwest CASC review.
- e. Manage appropriate post-site review follow-up and report writing. This includes post-site review summaries of key discussions and follow-up questions for the Midwest CASC principal investigators, staff, and/or students following each meeting. A conference call may be required following the Midwest CASC site review to identify necessary action steps and activities for report writing. **A concise, clear, informative, and timely report of the findings and recommendations of the External Review Team (not to exceed 35 pages) should be submitted to USGS/NCASC within forty-five (45) days of MW CASC site visit.**

(END OF SECTION C)

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

SECTION D – PACKAGING AND MARKING

D.1 GS0501 Packaging and Marking - Commercial Practice

July 2001

(a) Preservation, packaging, and marking for all items delivered hereunder shall be in accordance with standard commercial practice and adequate to insure acceptance by common carrier and safe arrival at destination.

(b) All containers shall be plainly marked on or adjacent to the exterior shipping label to show the contract number, task order number, description of contents, and contractor's name.

D.2 Delivery Addresses for Deliverables

The delivery address of any deliverables specified under this contract will be to:

U.S. Geological Survey
12201 Sunrise Valley Drive
Reston, VA 20192

D.3 Product Delivery - Storage-Handling

The Contractor shall arrange for deliveries of all materials to be delivered directly to the point of installation.

The Contractor shall be responsible for receiving deliveries on site at USGS and shall reconcile bills of lading for deliveries of contractor-furnished materials for the contracted project. Government personnel will not be responsible for reconciling bills of lading for contractor-furnished materials delivered to the USGS for a Contractor. The Contractor shall furnish a Contractor point-of-contact to vendors for receipt of material deliveries. The Contractor shall not provide the names of Government personnel to vendors as the point-of-contact for deliveries. The Contractor shall be responsible for scheduling and tracking the deliveries of all contractor-furnished materials for the project.

(END OF SECTION D)

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

SECTION E -- INSPECTION AND ACCEPTANCE

E.1 52.252-02 CLAUSES INCORPORATED BY REFERENCE FEB 1998

This contract incorporates one or more clauses by reference, with the same force and effect as if they were given in full text. Upon request, the Contracting Officer will make their full text available. Also, the full text of a clause may be accessed electronically at this address:

[FAR | Acquisition.GOV](http://FAR.Acquisition.GOV)

Clause	Title	Date
52.246-16	Responsibility for Supplies	April 1984

E.2 GS0715 PLACE OF INSPECTION JULY 2001

Government inspection of delivered items will be performed at destination by the COR or a Government authorized inspector.

E.3 FINAL INSPECTION AND ACCEPTANCE

Upon completion of the contracted work, the Contractor shall notify the COR. The COR will schedule an inspection of the work site and will perform the inspection at the site to determine if all work performed by the Contractor meets the requirements of the Statement of Work, Specifications and Drawings. The Contractor shall be present at the site during final inspection by the COR. The Date of Acceptance of the work by the Government will be determined by the Government after the final inspection has been performed.

E.4 GENERAL ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- General quality measures, as set forth below, will be applied to each work product received from the contractor under this Contract.
- Accuracy - Work shall be accurate in presentation, technical content, and adhere to accepted elements of style.
- Clarity - Work shall be clear and concise all diagrams shall be organized and relevant to the supporting narrative(s).
- Consistency to Requirements - All work shall satisfy the requirements of this contract.
- File Editing - All text and diagrammatic files shall be editable by the Government.
- Format - Work shall be submitted in hard copy (where applicable) and in media mutually agreed upon prior to submission, unless otherwise specified herein. Hard copy formats shall follow any specified Directives or Manuals.
- Timeliness - Work shall be submitted on or before the due date specified herein or submitted in accordance with a later scheduled date determined by the Government.

(END OF SECTION E)

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Reviews Support Services	Page 10 of 50
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	----------------------

SECTION F -- DELIVERIES OR PERFORMANCE

F.1 52.252-02 CLAUSES INCORPORATED BY REFERENCE

This contract incorporates one or more clauses by reference, with the same force and effect as if they were given in full text. Upon request, the Contracting Officer will make their full text available. Also, the full text of a clause may be accessed electronically at this address:

[FAR | Acquisition.GOV](http://FAR.Acquisition.GOV)

Clause	Title	Date
52.242-15	Stop-Work Order	August 1989

F.2 GS0905 PLACE OF PERFORMANCE JULY 2001

Services to be provided hereunder shall be performed at the following location(s):

US Geological Survey
12201 Sunrise Valley Drive
Reston, VA 20192

F.3 GS0911 PERIOD OF PERFORMANCE JULY 2001

Delivery of system is expected 90 days from date of award.

F.4 GS0916 PERIOD FOR EXERCISE OF OPTION TO EXTEND SERVICES JULY 2001

For the purposes described in FAR 37.111, the Government may exercise the option to extend the contract under the clause 52.217-8, Option to Extend Services, by written notice issued to the Contractor prior to the expiration of the initial contract period or any option period, including any previous extensions under this clause. When such date falls on the last day of a fiscal year, notification must be provided within 7 days after funds are appropriated and available for the new fiscal year.

F.5 GS0919 LEGAL HOLIDAYS JUNE 2021

The following legal holidays are observed by this Government agency:

New Year's Day	January 01
Martin Luther King's Birthday	3 rd Monday in January
Presidents Day	3 rd Monday in February
Memorial Day	Last Monday in May
Juneteenth	June 19
Independence Day	July 04
Labor Day	1 st Monday in September

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Reviews Support Services	Page 11 of 50
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	----------------------

Columbus Day	2 nd Monday in October
Veterans Day	November 11
Thanksgiving Day	4 th Thursday in November
Christmas Eve	December 24
Christmas Day	December 25

When a holiday falls on Saturday or Sunday, it is observed on the adjacent Friday or Monday, respectively. In addition to the holidays listed above, the contractor agrees to observe leave days or closures designated by Federal Statute, Executive Order, or Presidential Proclamation.

F.6 GS0924 Unscheduled Closures

July 2001

(a) The USGS facility where contractor employees are working may occasionally have unscheduled closures in which federal employees are dismissed on administrative leave (such as for inclement weather, holiday early closings, power outages, or other emergencies). In these cases, the Contracting Officer or COR will advise the contractor whether any of the contractor's activities are considered critical and require continued performance. In most cases, the Contractor employees not performing critical tasks will not be allowed to remain in the facility after federal employees are dismissed.

(b) If the contractor opts to treat these nonproductive hours as paid leave, these hours are billable at the established contract rates. The total number of hours billed on such days may not exceed the number scheduled for affected employees and may not include overtime hours.

(c) Paragraph (b) does not apply, and nonproductive hours are not billable as direct hours worked where the contractor's accounting system normally treats leave of the type used as an indirect or fringe benefit pool expense.

F.7 GS0925 Unscheduled Closures - Fixed Price

March 2003

(a) The USGS facility where contractor employees are working may occasionally be closed temporarily and federal employees dismissed, such as for inclement weather, holiday early closings, power outages, or other emergencies. In these cases, the Contracting Officer or COR will advise the contractor whether any of the contractor's activities on Government facilities are considered critical and require continued performance. In most cases, the Contractor will be required to dismiss employees at Government facilities who are performing noncritical tasks after federal employees are dismissed.

(b) If the unscheduled closure causes an increase in the cost of contract performance or if any contract term or condition is affected by the closure, the Contractor may request an adjustment pursuant to Clause FAR 52.242-17 Government Delay of Work.

(c) Contractor performance at locations that are not affected by the unscheduled closure will not be subject to this clause.

(END OF SECTION F)

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Reviews Support Services	Page 12 of 50
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	----------------------

SECTION G -- CONTRACT ADMINISTRATION DATA

G.1 GS1101 CONTRACT ADMINISTRATION OFFICE

JULY 2001

(a) This contract will be administered by:

United States Geological Survey
Terrence Hardy, Contracting Officer
terrence.hardy@ios.doi.gov
12201 Sunrise Valley Drive
Reston VA 20192

(b) Written communications to the Administrative Contracting Officer shall make reference to the contract number and shall be emailed to the above address.

G.2 DOI ELECTRONIC INVOICING Electronic Invoicing and Payment Requirements - Internet Payment Platform (IPP) (September 2011)

Payment requests must be submitted electronically through the U. S. Department of the Treasury's Internet Payment Platform System (IPP).

"Payment request" means any request for contract financing payment or invoice payment by the Contractor. To constitute a proper invoice, the payment request must comply with the requirements identified in the applicable Prompt Payment clause included in the contract, or the clause 52.212-4 Contract Terms and Conditions – Commercial Items included in commercial item contracts. The IPP website address is: <https://www.ipp.gov>.

Under this contract, the following documents are required to be submitted as an attachment to the IPP invoice:

Send a copy of the approved progress or final invoice for Contract. A cost breakdown of all products or services delivered and accepted by the Government and costs/prices associated with such deliverables. Contractor invoices must include all the informational detail required by the Prompt Payment clause, including but not limited to: Contract number; line items numbers; descriptions; quantities; unit prices; and period of performance. To constitute a proper invoice, the payment request must comply with the requirements identified in FAR 32.905(b), Payment documentation and process, and applicable Prompt Payment clause. Link to FAR 32.905(b): <http://farsite.hill.af.mil/vffara.htm>"

The Contractor must use the IPP website to register, access and use IPP for submitting requests for payment. The Contractor Government Business Point of Contact (as listed in CCR) will receive enrollment instructions via email from the Federal Reserve Bank of Boston (FRBB) within 3 - 5 business days of the original contract award date. Contractor assistance with enrollment can be obtained by contacting the IPP Production Helpdesk via email ippgroup@bos.frb.org or phone (866) 973-3131.

If the Contractor is unable to comply with the requirement to use IPP for submitting invoices for payment, the Contractor must submit a waiver request in writing to the contracting officer.

G.3 Technical Liaison-Technical Direction

(Jul 2018)

(a) The performance required herein shall be subject to the technical direction of the Technical Liaison (TL) as identified below. As used herein, "technical direction" is defined as direction to the contractor that fills in details, suggests possible lines of approach, or otherwise supplements the scope of the work set forth herein and shall not constitute a new assignment, and does not supersede or modify any article or clause of this contract.

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Reviews Support Services	Page 13 of 50
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	----------------------

(b) The Technical Liaison is not authorized to perform, formally or informally, any of the following actions:

(1) Promise, award, agree to award, or execute any contract modification, or notice of intent that changes or may change this contract;

(2) Waive or agree to modification of the delivery schedule;

(3) Make any final decision on any contract matter subject to the Disputes Clause;

(4) Terminate, for any reason, the contractor's right to proceed;

(5) Obligate in any way, the payment of money by the Government. Only a warranted Contracting Officer is authorized to obligate funds on this or any other contract action.

(c) The contractor shall immediately notify the Contracting Officer in writing if the Technical Liaison has taken an action (or fails to take action) or issues direction (written or oral) that the contractor considers exceeding the above limitations.

(d) The Technical Liaison assigned for this contract is:

TBD

(e) Only the Contracting Officer may designate a different Technical Liaison.

(End of Clause)

(END OF SECTION G)

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Reviews Support Services	Page 14 of 50
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	----------------------

SECTION H -- SPECIAL CONTRACT REQUIREMENTS

H.1 52.252-02 CLAUSES INCORPORATED BY REFERENCE

This contract incorporates one or more clauses by reference, with the same force and effect as if they were given in full text. Upon request, the Contracting Officer will make their full text available. Also, the full text of a clause may be accessed electronically at this address:

<http://www.acquisition.gov/far/>

Clause	Title	Date
52.202-01	Definitions	June 2020

H.2 GS1364 Nonpersonal Services and Supervision of Contractor's Employees (Sep 2017)

a. This contract is a "nonpersonal services contract" as defined in FAR 37.101. It is therefore, understood and agreed that the contractor and/or the contractor's employees:

- (1) shall perform the services specified herein as independent contractors, not as employees of the government;
- (2) shall request clarification in writing from the Contracting Officer if the Contractor finds it necessary with respect to the scope of services to be performed or the manner in which the services are to be performed hereunder;
- (3) shall be responsible for their own management and administration of the work required and bear sole responsibility for complying with any and all technical, schedule, or financial requirements or constraints attendant to the performance of this contract;
- (4) shall be free from supervision, direction or control by any government employee with respect to the manner or method of performance of the services specified; but
- (5) shall comply with such general direction of the Contracting Officer (or the duly authorized representative) pursuant to the government's right and obligation to inspect, accept or reject the work as is necessary to ensure accomplishment of the contract objectives.
- (6) shall not be at any time during the contract period employees of the U.S. Government.

b. The contractor's employees and subcontractors must make clear, in dealings with the public, federal employees, or other contractors that they are not federal employees. To minimize possible confusion, contractors and subcontractors are not permitted to wear clothing or other items (apart from official identity credential) bearing the name, logo, or seal of the U.S. Geological Survey while performing work under this contract.

c. (Applicable to contracts with individuals) The Government and the Contractor recognize and agree that no employer-employee relationship exists or will exist under the contract between the Government and the Contractor's personnel.

Both parties agree to each of the following:

- (1) Entitlement and benefits, including worker's compensation, applicable to an employer-employee relationship do not apply;
- (2) Payments by the Government under this contract will be reported to the IRS as payments to an independent contractor. The contractor is responsible for making payments of estimated taxes, Federal Insurance Contributions Act (FICA) and Medicare contributions, and other applicable federal, state and local taxes applicable to this income, directly to the relevant taxing authority.

H.3 GS1396 RELEASES OF INFORMATION JULY 2001

(a) Disclosure of information gained as a result of work performed under this contract shall be accomplished according to U.S. Geological Survey procedures or through USGS channels. As used in this clause, the term "information" includes raw data, data derivative there from, and analysis or interpretations thereof, regardless of form. The term includes data

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Reviews Support Services	Page 15 of 50
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	----------------------

developed or acquired by the contractor during performance of this contract, including analysis of samples provided by the Government and samples or recordings made by the contractor during contract performance.

(b) The contractor hereby agrees not to disclose such information to the public or to unauthorized parties without the prior written approval of the Contracting Officer. This restriction does not apply to releases of information to subcontractors (including consultants) as necessary for successful performance of the contract, provided (1) such information is of no commercial value to the subcontractor, and (2) the subcontractor agrees to be bound by the restrictions in this clause.

(c) After the contents of the contractor's final report have been made public by the Government, further releases of information may be made by the contractor, except for information subject to restrictions imposed elsewhere in this contract, if any. All releases must also comply with any additional restrictions which have been determined necessary by the Contracting Officer and provided to the contractor in writing.

(d) News releases pertaining to work under this contract shall not be made at any time without the approval and involvement of the cognizant Government Public Information Office.

H.4 GS1406

CONFIDENTIALITY OF DATA

OCTOBER 2005

(a) The work under this contract requires access to proprietary, business confidential, or financial data of other companies and/or USGS internal scientific, planning or procurement sensitive/source selection data, which, if released to third parties may give unfair business, technical, or competitive advantages. As long as such data remains proprietary or confidential, the contractor shall protect such data from unauthorized use and disclosure and agrees not to use it to compete with such companies or for any purpose other than performance of this contract.

(b) This data may be in various forms, such as documents, raw photographic films, magnetic or digital media, photographic prints, computer system data, or it may be interpretative results derived from analysis, investigative, or study effort. Regardless of the form of this data, the contractor agrees that neither it nor any of its employees will disclose to third parties any such data, or derivatives thereof, except as may be required in the performance of this contract. Further, the contractor will not copy any of this data, or derivatives thereof, other than as necessary for the performance of this contract.

(c) The contractor will establish policies and procedures to implement the substance of this clause at the individual employee level which will assure that affected employees are made aware of the contract provision and the contractor's implementing policies and procedures. Particular attention will be given to keeping employees advised of statutes and regulations applicable to the handling of third party confidential or financial data.

(d) This clause does not preclude the contractor and/or its employees from independently acquiring and using data from legitimate sources outside of this contract, or from performing and using independent analysis of data so acquired, provided that the contractor and/or its employees fully document the source of such data, and the independence of any such analysis.

(e) The Contractor shall immediately notify, in writing, the Contracting Officer in the event that the Contractor determines or has reason to suspect a breach of this requirement.

(f) The contractor will insert the substance of this clause in each subcontract hereunder (other than for purchase of supplies or equipment) unless the Contracting Officer has waived this requirement, in writing, as to particular subcontracts or classes of subcontracts.

(g) Any unauthorized disclosure of information may result in termination of this contract for cause.

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Reviews Support Services	Page 16 of 50
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	----------------------

H.5 GS1415 ACCESS TO GOVERNMENT FACILITIES JULY 2001

During the life of the contract, the rights of ingress and egress to and from the Government facility for Contractor personnel shall be made available as required. During all operations on Government premises, Contractor personnel shall comply with the rules and regulations governing the conduct of personnel and the operation of the facility. The Government reserves the right to require Contractor personnel to display photographic identification card (such as driver's license) and sign in upon ingress to and sign out upon egress from the Government facility.

H.6 GS1481 STANDARDS OF CONDUCT

The Contractor shall be responsible for maintaining satisfactory standards of employee competency, conduct, appearance, and integrity, and shall be responsible for taking such disciplinary action with respect to his employees as may be necessary. Each contractor employee is expected to adhere to standards of behavior that reflect credit on himself, his employer, and the Federal Government.

H.7 SUBCONTRACTOR CONTROL

The Contractor shall be the Prime Contractor in all cases. The contractor shall contact the COR to make all arrangements for Subcontractor personnel to gain access into the building. The Contractor shall bear complete responsibility of the work of Subcontractors, and shall supervise, direct and control the work of Subcontractors at all times.

H.8 GREEN ACQUISITION (July 2018)

The USGS is committed to promoting the natural environment and protecting the health and well-being of people. In the performance of work under this contract, the Contractor shall exert its best efforts to provide services in a manner that will promote the natural environment and protect health and well-being. Green purchasing or environmentally preferable contracting includes the initiatives described below:

Alternative Fuels and Vehicles are described at <http://www.afdc.energy.gov/afdc/>

Biobased Products are described at <http://www.biopreferred.gov/>

Energy efficient products are described at <http://energystar.gov/products> for Energy Star products and at <http://www.eere.energy.gov/femp/procurement> for FEMP designated products.

Environmentally Preferable Computers are described at <http://www.epeat.net>

Significant New Alternatives Program (SNAP) are described at <http://www.epa.gov/snap/overview-snap>

The Comprehensive Procurement Guidelines promote the use of recovered and recycled products at <https://www.epa.gov/smm/comprehensive-procurement-guideline-cpg-program>

Water efficient products and services are described at <https://www.epa.gov/watersense>

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Reviews Support Services	Page 17 of 50
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	----------------------

H.9 CORRESPONDENCE

To promote timely and effective administration, correspondence shall be subject to the following procedures.

- a. Technical correspondence (where technical issues relate to the compliance with requirements herein) shall be addressed to the Contracting Officers Representative (COR) with an information copy to the Contracting Officer (CO).
- b. All other correspondence, including invoices, shall be addressed to the Contracting Officer with an information copy to the COR.

H.10 PROJECT MANAGER

The Project Manager shall be the Contractor's authorized point of contact with the Government CO or COR. The Project Manager shall be responsible for formulating and enforcing work standards, assigning schedules, reviewing work discrepancies, and communicating policies, purposes, and goals of the organization to subordinates.

H.11 CONTRACTOR INTERFACES

The Contractor and/or their subcontractors may be required as part of the performance under the Contract to work with other contractors working for the Government. Such other contractors shall not direct the successful Contractor and/or their subcontractors in any manner. In addition, the successful Contractor and/or their subcontractors shall not direct the work of other contractors in any matter.

H.12 AUTHORITY TO OBLIGATE THE GOVERNMENT

The Contracting Officer is the only individual who can legally commit or obligate the Government to the expenditure of public funds. No cost chargeable to the proposed contract can be incurred before receipt of a fully executed contract and/or order or specific authorization from the Contracting Officer.

H.13 CONFIDENTIAL OR SENSITIVE INFORMATION

The work to be performed could place contractor personnel in situations where information is heard or seen that cannot be released to the public. Everything that is learned as the result of performance of this requirement shall be treated as sensitive in nature and shall not be discussed with anyone. All contractor personnel working under the Contract shall sign a Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) statement or confidentiality statement and provide it to the Contracting Officer at time of award.

(END OF SECTION H)

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Reviews Support Services	Page 18 of 50
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	----------------------

SECTION I -- CONTRACT CLAUSES

I.1 52.252-02 CLAUSES INCORPORATED BY REFERENCE

FEB 1998

This contract incorporates one or more clauses by reference, with the same force and effect as if they were given in full text. Upon request, the Contracting Officer will make their full text available. Also, the full text of a clause may be accessed electronically at this address:

[FAR | Acquisition.GOV](https://www.acquisition.gov)

Clause	Title	Date
52.202-01	Definitions	June 2020
52.203-03	Gratuities	April 1984
52.203-05	Covenant Against Contingent Fees	May 2014
52.203-07	Anti-Kickback Procedures	June 2020
52.203-08	Cancellation, Rescission, and Recovery of Funds for Illegal or Improper Activity	May 2014
52.203-12	Limitation on Payments to Influence Certain Federal Transactions	June 2020
52.203-16	Preventing Personal Conflicts of Interest	June 2020
52.203-17	Contractor Employee Whistleblower Rights	November 2023
52.203-19	Prohibition on Requiring Certain Internal Confidentiality Agreements or Statements.	January 2017
52.204-09	Personal Identity Verification of Contractor Personnel	January 2011
52.204-13	System for Award Management Maintenance	November 2025
52.204-19	Incorporation by Reference of Representations and Certifications	December 2014
52.209-6	Protecting the Government's Interest When Subcontracting With Contractors Debarred, Suspended, Proposed for Debarment, or Voluntarily Excluded.	November 2025
52.209-10	Prohibition on Contracting With Inverted Domestic Corporations.	November 2025
52.212-04	Contract Terms and Conditions—Commercial Products and Commercial Services	November 2025
52.217-8	Option to Extend Services	November 1999
52.222-3	Convict Labor	November 2025
52.222-35	Equal Opportunity for Veterans.	November 2025
52.222-36	Equal Opportunity for Workers with Disabilities.	November 2025
52.222-37	Employment Reports on Veterans.	November 2025
52.222-41	Service Contract Labor Standards.	November 2025
52.222-50	Combating Trafficking in Persons	November 2025
52.222-54	Employment Eligibility Verification.	November 2025
52.222-62	Paid Sick Leave Under Executive Order 13706.	November 2025
52.223-23	Sustainable Products and Services	November 2025
52.226-08	Encouraging Contractor Policies To Ban Text Messaging While Driving	May 2024
52.227-01	Authorization and Consent	June 2020
52.227-14	Rights in Data--General	May 2014

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Reviews Support Services	Page 19 of 50
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	----------------------

52.232-33	Payment by Electronic Funds Transfer - System for Award Management	October 2018
52.232-40	Providing Accelerated Payments to Small Business Subcontractors	March 2023
52.233-03	Protest after Award.	November 2025
52.233-04	Applicable Law for Breach of Contract Claim.	November 2025
52.240-90	Security Prohibitions and Exclusions Representations and Certifications.	November 2025
52.240-91	Security Prohibitions and Exclusions.	November 2025
52.242-13	Bankruptcy	July 1995

I.2. 52.222-42 Statement of Equivalent Rates for Federal Hires (MAY 2014)

In compliance with the Service Contract Labor Standards statute and the regulations of the Secretary of Labor (29 CFR part 4), this clause identifies the classes of service employees expected to be employed under the contract and states the wages and fringe benefits payable to each if they were employed by the contracting agency subject to the provisions of 5 U.S.C. 5341 or 5332. This Statement is for Information Only: It Is Not A Wage Determination Employee class Monetary wage - Fringe benefits []

(End of clause)

I.3 52.217-8 OPTION TO EXTEND SERVICES NOVEMBER 1999

The Government may require continued performance of any services within the limits and at the rates specified in the contract. These rates may be adjusted only as a result of revisions to prevailing labor rates provided by the Secretary of Labor. The option provision may be exercised more than once, but the total extension of performance hereunder shall not exceed 6 months. The Contracting Officer may exercise the option by written notice to the Contractor within 7 days of the end of the Contract period of performance.

(End Clause)

I.4 52.217-9 OPTION TO EXTEND THE TERM OF THE CONTRACT MARCH 2000

- (a) The Government may extend the term of this contract by written notice to the Contractor within *30 days*; provided that the Government gives the Contractor a preliminary written notice of its intent to extend at least *30 days* before the contract expires. The preliminary notice does not commit the Government to an extension.
- (b) If the Government exercises this option, the extended contract shall be considered to include this option clause.
- (c) The total duration of this contract, including the exercise of any options under this clause, shall not exceed *5 years 6 months*.

(End of clause)

I.5 1452.203-70 RESTRICTION ON ENDORSEMENTS--DEPARTMENT OF THE INTERIOR JULY 1996

The Contractor shall not refer to contracts awarded by the Department of the Interior in commercial advertising, as defined in FAR 31.205-1, in a manner which states or implies that the product or service provided is approved or endorsed

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Reviews Support Services	Page 20 of 50
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	----------------------

by the Government, or is considered by the Government to be superior to other products or services. This restriction is intended to avoid the appearance of preference by the Government toward any product or service. The Contractor may request the Contracting Officer to make a determination as to the propriety of promotional material.

I.6 1452.233-2 SERVICE OF PROTEST -- DEPARTMENT OF THE JULY 1996
INTERIOR (JUL 1996) (DEVIATION)

(a) Protests, as defined in section 33.101 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation, that are filed directly with an agency, and copies of any protests that are filed with the Government Accountability Office (GAO), shall be served on the Contracting Officer (addressed as follows) by obtaining written and dated acknowledgment of receipt from Department of the Interior Assistant Solicitor for Procurement and Patents, 1849 C Street, NW, Room 6511, Washington, D.C. 20240.

(b) The copy of any protest shall be received in the office designated above within one day of filing a protest with the GAO.

c) A copy of the protest served on the Contracting Officer shall be simultaneously furnished by the protester to the Department of the Interior Assistant Solicitor for Procurement and Patents, 1849 C Street, NW, Room 6511, Washington, D.C. 20240.

(END OF SECTION I)

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

SECTION J – LIST OF ATTACHMENTS**J.1 LIST OF ATTACHMENTS**

Document	Title	No. of Pages
Attachment A	Experience Project Data Sheet	2
Attachment B	Past Performance Questionnaires	6

(END OF SECTION J)

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

SECTION K – REPRESENTATIONS, CERTIFICATION, AND OTHER STATEMENTS OF OFFERORS

K.1 52.209-07 INFORMATION REGARDING RESPONSIBILITY MATTERS NOV 2025

(a) *Definitions.* As used in this provision—

Administrative proceeding means a non-judicial process that is adjudicatory in nature in order to make a determination of fault or liability (e.g., Securities and Exchange Commission Administrative Proceedings, Civilian Board of Contract Appeals Proceedings, and Armed Services Board of Contract Appeals Proceedings). This includes administrative proceedings at the Federal and State level but only in connection with performance of a Federal contract or grant. It does not include agency actions such as contract audits, site visits, corrective plans, or inspection of deliverables.

Federal contracts and grants with total value greater than \$10,000,000 means—

- (1) The total value of all current, active contracts and grants, including all priced options; and
- (2) The total value of all current, active orders including all priced options under indefinite-delivery, indefinite-quantity, 8(a), or requirements contracts (including task and delivery and multiple-award Schedules).

Principal means an officer, director, owner, partner, or a person having primary management or supervisory responsibilities within a business entity (e.g., general manager; plant manager; head of a division or business segment; and similar positions).

(b) The offeror ☐ has ☐ does not have current active Federal contracts and grants with total value greater than \$10,000,000.

(c) If the offeror checked "has" in paragraph (b) of this provision, the offeror represents, by submission of this offer, that the information it has entered in the Federal Awardee Performance and Integrity Information System (FAPIS) is current, accurate, and complete as of the date of submission of this offer with regard to the following information:

(1) Whether the offeror, and/or any of its principals, has or has not, within the last five years, in connection with the award to or performance by the offeror of a Federal contract or grant, been the subject of a proceeding, at the Federal or State level that resulted in any of the following dispositions:

- (i) In a criminal proceeding, a conviction.
- (ii) In a civil proceeding, a finding of fault and liability that results in the payment of a monetary fine, penalty, reimbursement, restitution, or damages of \$5,000 or more.
- (iii) In an administrative proceeding, a finding of fault and liability that results in—
 - (A) The payment of a monetary fine or penalty of \$5,000 or more; or
 - (B) The payment of a reimbursement, restitution, or damages in excess of \$100,000.
- (iv) In a criminal, civil, or administrative proceeding, a disposition of the matter by consent or compromise with an acknowledgment of fault by the Contractor if the proceeding could have led to any of the outcomes specified in paragraphs (c)(1)(i), (c)(1)(ii), or (c)(1)(iii) of this provision.

(2) If the offeror has been involved in the last five years in any of the occurrences listed in (c)(1) of this provision, whether the offeror has provided the requested information with regard to each occurrence.

(d) The offeror shall post the information in paragraphs (c)(1)(i) through (c)(1)(iv) of this provision in FAPIS as required through maintaining an active registration in the System for Award Management, which can be accessed via <https://www.sam.gov> (see 52.204-7).

(End of provision)

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

DEPARTMENT OF THE INTERIOR (MODIFIED)

a) Definitions. For the purposes of this provision and the Freedom of Information Act (5 U.S.C. 552), the following terms shall have the meaning set forth below:

(1) "Trade Secret" means an unpatented, secret, commercially valuable plan, appliance, formula, or process, which is used for making, preparing, compounding, treating or processing articles or materials which are trade commodities.

(2) "Confidential commercial or financial information" means any business information (other than trade secrets) which is exempt from the mandatory disclosure requirement of the Freedom of Information Act, 5 U.S.C. 552. Exemptions from mandatory disclosure which may be applicable to business information contained in quotations include exemption (4), which covers "commercial and financial information obtained from a person and privileged or confidential," and exemption (9), which covers "geological and geophysical information, including maps, concerning wells."

(b) If the offeror, or its subcontractor(s), believes that the quotation contains trade secrets, or confidential commercial or financial information exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act, (5 U.S.C. 552), the cover page of each copy of the quotation shall be marked with the following legend:

"The information specifically identified on pages _____ of this quotation constitutes trade secrets or confidential commercial and financial information which the offeror believes to be exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act. The offeror requests that this information not be disclosed to the public, except as may be required by law. The offeror also requests that this information not be used in whole or part by the government for any purpose other than to evaluate the quotation, except that if a contract is awarded to the offeror as a result of or in connection with the submission of the quotation, the Government shall have the right to use the information to the extent provided in the contract."

(c) The offeror shall also specifically identify trade secret information and confidential commercial and financial information on the pages of the quotation on which it appears and shall mark each such page with the following legend:

"This page contains trade secrets or confidential commercial and financial information which the offeror believes to be exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act and which is subject to the legend contained on the cover page of this quotation."

(d) Information in a quotation identified by an offeror as trade secret information or confidential commercial and financial information shall be used by the Government only for the purpose of evaluating the quotation, except that (i) if a contract is awarded to the offeror as a result of or in connection with submission of the quotation, the Government shall have the right to use the information as provided in the contract, and (ii) if the same information is obtained from another source without restriction it may be used without restriction.

(e) If a request under the Freedom of Information Act seeks access to information in a quotation identified as trade secret information or confidential commercial and financial information, full consideration will be given to the offeror's view that the information constitutes trade secrets or confidential commercial or financial information. The offeror will also be promptly notified of the request and given an opportunity to provide additional evidence and argument in support of its position, unless administratively unfeasible to do so. If it is determined that information claimed by the offeror to be trade secret information or confidential commercial or financial information is not exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act, the offeror will be notified of this determination prior to disclosure of the information.

(f) The Government assumes no liability for the disclosure or use of information contained in a quotation if not marked in accordance with paragraphs (b) and (c) of this provision. If a request under the Freedom of Information Act is made for information in a quotation not marked in accordance with paragraphs (b) and (c) of this provision, the offeror concerned

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

shall be promptly notified of the request and given an opportunity to provide its position to the Government. However, failure of an offeror to mark information contained in a quotation as trade secret information or confidential commercial or financial information will be treated by the Government as evidence that the information is not exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act, absent a showing that the failure to mark was due to unusual or extenuating circumstances, such as a showing that the offeror had intended to mark, but that markings were omitted from the offeror's quotation due to clerical error.

(END OF SECTION K)

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

SECTION L – INSTRUCTIONS, CONDITIONS, AND NOTICES TO OFFERORS

L.1 52.252-01 SOLICITATION PROVISIONS INCORPORATED BY REFERENCE Feb 1998

This solicitation incorporates one or more solicitation provisions by reference, with the same force and effect as if they were given in full text. Upon request, the Contracting Officer will make their full text available. The offeror is cautioned that the listed provisions may include blocks that must be completed by the offeror and submitted with its quotation or offer. In lieu of submitting the full text of those provisions, the offeror may identify the provision by paragraph identifier and provide the appropriate information with its quotation or offer. Also, the full text of a solicitation provision may be accessed electronically at this/these address(es): <http://www.acquisition.gov/far/> or <http://farsite.hill.af.mil/vffara.htm>

Provision	Title	Date
52.212-1	Instruction to Offerors – Commercial Items	November 2025

L.2 52.216-1 TYPE OF CONTRACT November 2025

The Government contemplates award of a *Firm Fixed Price* contract resulting from this solicitation.

L.3 52.233-02 SERVICE PROTEST November 2025

(a) Protests, (as defined in FAR 33.102), that are filed directly with an agency, and copies of any protests that are filed with the Government Accountability Office (GAO), must be served on the Contracting Officer identified in the solicitation by obtaining written and dated acknowledgment of receipt from them.

(b) The copy of any protest must be received in the office designated above within one day of filing a protest with the GAO.

(End of provision)

L.4 52.237-1 SITE VISIT APRIL 1984

Offerors or quoters are urged and expected to inspect the site where services are to be performed and to satisfy themselves regarding all general and local conditions that may affect the cost of contract performance, to the extent that the information is reasonably obtainable. In no event shall failure to inspect the site constitute grounds for a claim after contract award.

(End of provision)

L.5 1452.233-2 SERVICE OF PROTEST -- DEPARTMENT OF THE INTERIOR (JUL 1996) (DEVIATION) JULY 1996

(a) Protests, as defined in section 33.101 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation, that are filed directly with an agency, and copies of any protests that are filed with the Government Accountability Office (GAO), shall be served on the Contracting Officer (addressed as follows) by obtaining written and dated acknowledgment of receipt from Department of the Interior Assistant Solicitor for Procurement and Patents, 1849 C Street, NW, Room 6511, Washington, D.C. 20240.

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

(b) The copy of any protest shall be received in the office designated above within one day of filing a protest with the GAO.

c) A copy of the protest served on the Contracting Officer shall be simultaneously furnished by the protester to the Department of the Interior Assistant Solicitor, Acquisitions and Intellectual Property, 1849 C Street, NW, Room 6511, Washington, D.C. 20240.

L.6 GS2101 INQUIRIES (MODIFIED)

FEBRUARY 2007

Offerors are instructed to contact only the solicitation Issuing Office shown on page 1 (Block 9 on SF 1449) for information about any aspect of the solicitation. Prospective offerors are cautioned against contacting Government technical personnel in regard to this solicitation prior to award of this procurement. If such a contact occurs and is found to be prejudicial to competing offerors, the offeror making such a contact may be excluded from award consideration. Accordingly, all communications prior to award must be directed to the Contracting Officer named on page 1 (Block 31b on SF 1449). Inquiries must be submitted in writing by e-mail. Questions should be worded so as to avoid disclosing bid strategies or proprietary solutions.

Questions shall be submitted via email to the Contracting Officer at Terrence hardy@ios.doi.gov by Friday, May 10, 2026, at 12:00PM EST. Reference RFQ# 140G0126Q0118 – External Support Services in the email subject line. The government is under no obligation to answer questions received after this date.

L.7 GS2107 Electronic Transmission of Offers (Deviation)

JULY 2001

- 1) One copy of each quotation (Technical and Price) is to be submitted by electronic mail (e-mail) in PDF, MS Word or another format that best fits the offeror's quotation format. Technical and pricing information are to be transmitted as separate files (Technical Quotation – Volume I; Pricing – Volume II) where subfiles (i.e. File 1, 2, 2.1, 2.2 etc.) are to be included in the specified volumes.
- 2) The government is not responsible for ensuring adequate email storage space is available for all responses. The Government is not responsible for any failure attributable to transmission or receipt of the email, including but not limited to (1) availability, of receiving email, (2) delays in transmission or receipt, (3) failure of the offeror to properly identify the transmitted document, or (4) security of quotation data. An email submission which does not arrive, in its entirety, by the time, specified in the solicitation for receipt of offers will be regarded as late.
- 3) Email submissions must identify the solicitation number (140G0126Q0118) in the subject line.
- 4) **A complete quotation package shall be submitted via email to terrence hardy@ios.doi.gov no later than Friday, May 22 at 5:00PM ET. Reference RFQ# 140G0126Q0118 in the email subject line.**

L.8 GS2112 INVOLVEMENT OF CURRENT/FORMER EMPLOYEES

AUGUST 2001

(a) Awards to current Government employees, or firms owned or controlled by them, their spouse or minor child, are restricted by FAR 3.601 to exceptional cases approved by the Head of the Contracting Activity. Restrictions regarding current employees apply to regular employees and special Government employees (such as WAE), as those terms are defined in 43 CFR Section 20.735-1. To avoid an appearance of impropriety, preferential treatment, or unfair competitive advantage, the U.S. Geological Survey has established additional disclosure and review requirements for awards to or

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

involving former USGS regular employees.

(b) The prospective contractor must provide a disclosure statement in its quotation identifying any current Government employees or former USGS employees who will be involved in the quotation and/or resultant contract and the nature of their involvement or financial interests, if

- (1) The offeror is a current Government employee, such employee's spouse or minor child, or a former USGS employee;
- (2) The offeror is a business concern substantially owned or controlled by one or more current Government employees or such employee's spouse or minor child, or a former USGS employee; or
- (3) The offeror has employed in the preparation of this quotation or plans to employ on any contract resulting from this solicitation a current Government employee or former USGS employee.

(c) Disclosure requirements regarding former employees are limited to former regular employees of the USGS whose USGS employment terminated within two years prior to submission of this quotation. Involvement of such employees, either in preparing the quotation or under any resultant contract, is not necessarily precluded, but each case must be reviewed against standards of conduct and procurement integrity restrictions on former employees.

L.9 GS2113 ORGANIZATIONAL CONFLICT OF INTEREST JULY 2001 DISCLOSURE

(a) The contracting officer considers that there is potential for organizational conflicts of interest involving this procurement or services to be performed under the resultant contracts, as follows:

(b) If the prospective Contractor is aware of any information bearing on the existence of any potential organizational conflict of interest, as defined in FAR 9.5, it shall provide a disclosure statement in its quotation which describes all relevant information concerning any past, present, or planned interests bearing on whether it (including its chief executives and directors, or any proposed consultant or subcontractor) may have a potential organizational conflict of interest.

(c) If the Contracting Officer determines that a potential conflict exists, the prospective Contractor shall not receive an award unless the conflict can be avoided or otherwise resolved through the inclusion of a special contract clause or other appropriate means. The terms of any special clause are subject to negotiation. Prospective Contractors should refer to FAR Subpart 9.5 for policies and procedures for avoiding, neutralizing, or mitigating organizational conflicts of interest.

L.10 GS2115 INDEPENDENT REVIEW OF PROTESTS TO THE AGENCY JULY 2001

Interested parties may request an independent review at a level above the Contracting Officer of protests filed directly with the agency. This review is available as an appeal of the Contracting Officer's response to the protest. Requests for independent review shall be submitted to the Chief of the acquisition office issuing the solicitation, who will designate the official(s) to conduct the independent review.

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

L.11 SYSTEM FOR AWARD MANAGEMENT

The contract resulting from this solicitation will contain FAR clause 52.232-33, "Payment by Electronic Funds Transfer—System for Award Management." All Contractors receiving payments under USGS contracts, purchase orders, delivery orders, or other contractual vehicles must be registered in the System for Award Management (SAM) database. The SAM is a Department of Defense web-based repository of Contractor information. The Electronic Funds Transfer information in the SAM must be accurate in order for Contractors' invoices or contract financing requests to be considered proper invoices for the purpose of prompt payment under DOI contracts.

Interested offerors should read and understand the requirements of FAR 52.232-33. The successful offeror must register in the SAM before submitting any invoices or contract financing instruments to the USGS, and must maintain current, updated information in SAM throughout the performance period of the contract. Offerors can register in SAM at any time and are encouraged to do so immediately.

Offerors may register in the SAM database and obtain additional information at <http://www.sam.gov/> or by calling 1-888-227-2423. The Contractor is responsible for the accuracy and completeness of the data within the SAM, and for any liability resulting from the DOI's reliance on inaccurate or incomplete data. To remain registered in the SAM database after the initial registration, the Contractor must confirm on an annual basis that its information in the database is accurate and complete.

L.12 INCURRING COSTS

The Contracting Officer is the only person who can legally obligate the Government for the expenditure of public funds. Costs shall not be incurred by recipients of the solicitation in anticipation of receiving direct reimbursement from the Government. It is understood that your quotation will become part of the official file on this matter without obligation to the Government.

L.14 ADMINISTRATIVE POINT OF CONTACT

Offerors shall direct all questions to the Contracting Officer via e-mail at trhardy@usgs.gov only.

L.15 HAND CARRIED OR FACSIMILE BIDS

Facsimile or hand carried quotations will not be considered or accepted for this solicitation.

L.16 PROCUREMENT INTEGRITY ACT

Offerors' attention is directed to FAR 3.104-5 for a discussion on marking and proprietary quotation information. Offerors should put the following notice on the top of each copy of its quotation:

"This quotation shall be used and disclosed for evaluation purposes only, and a copy of this Government notice shall be applied to any reproduction or abstract thereof. Any authorized restrictive notices that the submitter places on this quotation shall also be strictly complied with. Disclosure of this quotation outside the Government for evaluation purposes shall be made only to the extent authorized by, and in accordance with, law."

L.17 GS2150 QUOTATION FORMAT AND SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS (Modified)

Quotes submitted in response to solicitation 140G0120Q0203 must be formatted in accordance with all directions and details stated herein.

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

- The quote must contain a Quote cover page
- The quote must contain a table of contents. The table of contents and the quote must follow the same order as is stated herein for the different sections.
- The quote must contain an acknowledgement page
- The quote must contain a cover page for each section and subsections. On this cover page, no contractor identifiable information shall be stated. This cover page will not count towards the total page count for its respective section. All of the sections are subject to the page limitations as stated below.

A failure to follow any of the directions previously stated or stated throughout this solicitation and the government reserves the right to deem the offer unacceptable, and as such, the offeror may be eliminated from competition.

L.17.1 Quotation Cover Page to include the following:

- Company Name
- Contractor's Address
- Company Tax ID Number
- DUNS Number
- CAGE Number
- Point-of-contact information
- Solicitation number to which the Quote applies
- NAICS Code under which this opportunity is being solicited

L.17.2 Acknowledgement Page to include the following:

- Statement of Acknowledgement that the offeror has received and reviewed all of the documents (including the base solicitation and all amendments, appendices, attachments and all other documents for this opportunity) that were available on the RFQ.
- Statement of Acknowledgement that the offeror understands and guarantees their quote, whether it be the original, or a revised after formal negotiations take place, for a period of 90 days of receipt by the government of their final offer.
- The name and contact information of an individual who is the authorized POC for all correspondences, for pre-award communications.
- A signature from an authorized individual, which must include the individual's name, title, signature and date.

L.17.3 Quotation Acceptance Period:

Notwithstanding FAR Clause 52.212-1, the response must be valid for a period of 90 days after their final offer has been made. The offeror shall make a clear statement in their response acknowledgement page that it is valid until this period has ended.

L.17.4 Response Preparation Costs:

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

The Government shall not be liable for any costs incurred by the offeror for the preparation and submission of the quote in response to this opportunity.

L.17.5 Late Responses:

An offeror who misses the deadline for the submission of the quote will not be accepted, nor will it be evaluated, unless so authorized by law.

L.17.6 Page Set-up:

The quote must be set-up in accordance with the following standards:

- Size of Paper - Standard Letter Size Paper shall be used (8.5" x 11")
- Spacing - Single Spaced
- Margins - 1 inch margins around the entire paper
- Font - Times New Roman
- Font Size - 12 point

In addition to the page set-up standards stated above, the following shall be used as well:

- All pages shall be numbered under each section. The page numbering shall start over for each section, so that there is no question about whether each section has followed the stated limitations.

L.17.7 Contents of Each Section:

The required contents for each section are as follows:

Section 1: Non Price Factors

Factor 1 – Technical Approach:

(a) Solicitation Submittal Requirements:

The composition and management of the firms Understanding of the work, including creativity and thoroughness shown in understanding the objectives of the SOW, specific tasks, and planned execution of the project.

The Offeror shall submit the following information:

- (1) Provide a narrative describing the effectiveness of the offeror's logical and effective approach for meeting the methods described in the SOW tasks.

The technical approach narrative shall be limited to ten (10) single-sided pages). The information requested in item #2 below is not included in this page limitation.

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

(2) In addition to the narrative, the Offeror shall submit a signed copy of a joint venture agreement, partnership agreement, teaming agreement, approved mentor protégé agreement (MPA), or letter of commitment for each member of the Offeror's team identified above (e.g., joint venture member, partner, team member, subcontractor, parent company, subsidiary, or other affiliated company, etc.).

Factor 2 – Key Personnel:

(a) Solicitation Submittal Requirements:

This factor addresses the suitability and of the personnel that the offeror has proposed as well as their plans for continuing to provide and manage a qualified workforce.

The Offeror shall submit the following information:

- (1) Provide a narrative demonstrating the key personnel offered; the currency, quality and depth of experience of individual personnel working on similar projects. Similar projects must convey similarity in topic, dollar value, workload, duration, and complexity. Include a staffing plan, resumes for key personnel and a description of your current personnel resources for this, which addresses their capabilities and experience relating to the attached Performance work statement

The narrative shall be limited to fifteen (15) single-sided pages.

Factor 3 – Experience:

(a) Solicitation Submittal Requirements:

The Offeror shall submit the following information:

(1) Experience:

Submit a minimum of three (3) and a maximum of five (5) relevant projects for the Offeror that best demonstrates your experience on relevant projects that are similar in size, scope, and complexity to the RFQ. For purposes of this evaluation, a relevant project is further defined as a project similar in size, scope, and complexity to the PWS.

Projects submitted for the Offeror shall be completed within the past five (5) years of the date of issuance of this RFQ.

The attached Experience Project Data Sheet (Attachment 1) is MANDATORY and SHALL be used to submit project information. Except as specifically requested, the Government will not consider information submitted in addition to this form. Individual blocks on this form may be expanded; however, total length for each project data sheet shall not exceed two (2) single-sided pages.

For all submitted projects, the description of the project shall clearly describe the scope of work performed and the relevancy to the project requirements of this RFQ.

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

If the Offeror is a Joint Venture (JV), relevant project experience should be submitted for projects completed by the Joint Venture entity. If the Joint Venture does not have shared experience, projects may be submitted for the Joint Venture members. Offerors who fail to submit experience for all Joint Venture members may be rated lower. Offerors are still limited to a total of five (5) projects combined.

If an Offeror is utilizing experience information of affiliates/subsidiaries/parent/LLC/LTD member companies (name is not exactly as stated on the SF1449), the Quote shall clearly demonstrate that the affiliate/subsidiary/parent firm will have meaningful involvement in the performance of the contract.

Factor 4 – Past Performance:

(a) Solicitation Submittal Requirements:

If a completed Contractor Performance Appraisal Report (CPAR) evaluation is available, it shall be submitted with the Quote for each project included in Factor 3 for experience. If there is not a completed CPAR evaluation then submit Past Performance Questionnaires (Attachment 2) for each project included in Factor 3 for Experience. The Offeror should provide completed Past Performance Questionnaires (PPQ) in the Quote. Offerors shall not incorporate by reference into their Quote PPQs previously submitted for other RFQs. However, this does not preclude the Government from utilizing previously submitted PPQ information in the past performance evaluation. If the Offeror is unable to obtain a completed PPQ from a client for a project(s) before Quote closing date, the Offeror shall complete and submit with the Quote the first page of the PPQ, which will provide contract and client information for the respective project(s). The Government may make reasonable attempts to contact the client noted for that project(s) to obtain the PPQ information. However, Offerors should follow-up with clients/references to help ensure timely submittal of questionnaires. If the client requests, questionnaires may be submitted directly to the Government's point of contact, Terrence Hardy, trhardy@USGS.gov.

Offerors may provide any information on problems encountered and the corrective actions taken on projects submitted under Factor 3 – Experience. Offerors may also address any adverse past performance issues. Explanations shall not exceed two (2) double-sided pages (or four (4) single-sided pages) in total.

The Government reserves the right to contact references for verification or additional information. The Government's inability to contact any of the Offeror's references or the references unwillingness to provide the information requested may affect the Government's evaluation of this factor.

Performance award or additional information submitted will not be considered.

If the offeror has no record of past performance, they must/shall submit a signed and dated statement to that effect. If no past performance information is available, the offeror will be evaluated as neutral.

The offeror will only get credit for what is submitted within each section, and as such, if information is included in incorrect sections, the government reserves the right to deem that quote unacceptable and it may be eliminated from competition on this basis alone.

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

Section 2 - Price Quote

(a) Solicitation Submittal Requirements:

The offeror shall complete and submit the Standard Form (SF) 1449. With regard to price as shown on the SF 1449, the only Contract Line Item that Offerors are to complete is Line Item 0100 thru 1001 of the Price Schedule of the Solicitation. The offeror shall also provide the proposed Labor Categories, rates and hours that establish each 12 month period of performance Total Price.

Section 3 - Conditions for Award

a. Assumptions, Conditions, and Exceptions

The Offeror must submit a separate statement that states all (if any) assumptions, conditions, or exceptions with any of the contractual, technical, and/or cost/price terms and conditions of this Request for Quote (RFQ). If no assumptions, conditions or exceptions exist than a statement must be made stating this. It is not the responsibility of the Government to seek out and identify assumptions, conditions, or exceptions buried within the Offeror's submission.

Assumptions, conditions or exceptions which an offeror sets forth may affect the acceptability of its Quote, and as such, the government reserves the right to reject a Quote on this basis alone.

b. Representations and Certifications

The following representations and certifications shall be submitted within this section:

- **FAR 52.209-11 Representation by Corporations Regarding Delinquent Tax Liability or a Felony Conviction under any Federal Law (NOV 2025)**

Miscellaneous:

Each section of the quote shall be written on a stand-alone basis so that its contents may be evaluated without the need to cross-reference to any other section of the quote.

Each section will be evaluated on a standalone basis. The information included within the each respective section will be the only information that the contractor will get credit for. Information that is required to be submitted within a particular section and that information is not found within that section that information will be evaluated under the section it was included in and against the relevant standards of that section.

It is the contractor's responsibility to ensure that the quote and the contents therein are clear and precise.

L.17.8 Notice to Offerors

Award Information

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

The government anticipates making a single award for a Firm Fixed price contract for a base period of twelve months, with one (1) twelve month option perios, as well as option clause 52.217-8.

(END OF SECTION L)

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

SECTION M – EVALUATION FACTORS and BASIS FOR AWARD

M.1 EVALUATION, EVALUATION FACTORS AND BASIS FOR AWARD

The Government intends to award a single firm-fixed price Purchase Order resulting from this solicitation to the responsible offeror whose offer has been determined to be the Best Value Quotation.

The Contracting Officer will screen quotation packages to identify and eliminate any offer that is so incomplete or non-conforming to the instructions or terms and conditions of the RFQ or other RFQ requirements, as to preclude a meaningful evaluation. The Contracting Officer reserves the right to eliminate any offer from further evaluation or consideration for award if that offeror's quotation package fails to comply or conform to the RFQ's minimum specifications, instructions or terms and conditions, or is missing information requested in this solicitation.

The Contracting Officer reserves the right to request additional information after the RFQ closing date. The Government intends to award without requesting additional information from the offerors or requesting a revised quotation packages. However, if required, the offeror will be requested to submit additional information and if applicable a revised quotation package. The final quotation package will be evaluated and if the offeror's quotation package is determined the Best Value offer using trade-off procedures, it will be awarded in accordance with the terms and conditions and specifications of this RFQ.

Quotations will be evaluated using Trade-Off procedures. All evaluation factors other than price, when combined, are significantly more important than price; however, price is an important factor and should be considered when preparing quotation packages.

M.1.1 Non Price Factors Evaluation

Factor 1 – Technical Approach:

(a) Basis of Evaluation:

The Offeror's technical approach will be evaluated on the manner in which the Offeror proposes to plan, manage, control, and provide the services and deliverables specified. The Offeror's proposed technical and management approach must include a performance management and control process that tracks milestones, schedule, and staff and contract performance.

Factor 2 – Key Personnel:

(a) Basis of Evaluation:

The Offeror's proposed staff will be evaluated based on descriptions of roles, submitted resumes, and "Letters of Commitment" illustrating an appropriate mix of knowledge, skills, expertise, and experience of proposed technical, management, and project support staff.

Factor 3 – Experience:

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

(a) Basis of Evaluation:

The basis of evaluation will include the Offeror's demonstrated experience and depth of experience in performing relevant projects as defined in the solicitation submittal requirements. The assessment of the Offeror's relevant experience will be used as a means of evaluating the capability of the Offeror to successfully meet the requirements of the RFQ. The Government will only review five projects. Any projects submitted in excess of the five (5) for Experience will not be considered.

Offerors who submit relevant projects that demonstrate experience self-performing relevant features of work may receive a higher rating than those who do not demonstrate self performance.

Relevancy is defined as experience similar to the tasks defined in the SOW.

Factor 4 – Past Performance:

(a) Basis of Evaluation:

This evaluation focuses on how well the Offeror performed on the relevant projects submitted under Factor 3 – Experience and past performance on other projects currently documented in known sources. More emphasis will be placed on more relevant projects. In addition to the above, the Government reserves the right to obtain information for use in the evaluation of past performance from any and all sources including sources outside of the Government. Other sources may include, but are not limited to, past performance information retrieved through the Past Performance Information Retrieval System (PPIRS) using all CAGE/DUNS numbers of Contractors who are part of a partnership or joint venture identified in the Offeror's Quote, inquiries of owner representative(s), Federal Awardee Performance and Integrity Information System (FAPIS), Electronic Subcontract Reporting System (eSRS), and any other known sources not provided by the Offeror.

The Government will consider the quality of that performance, and the degree of confidence the Government places in each offeror's ability to meet its requirements in the Contractor's performance. This evaluation is separate and distinct from the Contracting Officer's responsibility determination. The assessment of the Offeror's past performance will be used as a means of evaluating the Offeror's probability to successfully meet the requirements of the RFQ.

M.1.2 Price Quote

Basis of Evaluation:

The price Quote for the Total Price will be evaluated to determine the reasonableness and completeness of the Offeror's Quote.

The ordering activity shall consider level of effort and mix of labor proposed to perform a specific task being ordered, and for determining that the total proposed price is reasonable.

Request for Quotation	Document No. 140G0126Q0118	Document Title External Review Support Svs	
------------------------------	--------------------------------------	--	--

Any inconsistency whether real or apparent, between proposed performance and price must be clearly explained in the price Quote. For example, if unique and innovative approaches are the basis for an apparently unbalanced/inconsistently priced Quote, the nature of these approaches and their impact on price must be completely documented. The burden of proof of price reasonableness rests solely with the Offeror.

M.2 Conditions for Award

The following list of items must be submitted and accepted by the government in order for the offeror to be eligible to receive the award for this opportunity.

M.2.1 Assumptions, Conditions, and Exceptions

The statement from the offeror, which either outlines their assumptions, conditions and exceptions or states that there are none present, will be categorized as either pass or fail.

M.2.2 Representations and Certifications

The required representations and certifications must be submitted through www.SAM.Gov for FAR 52.212-3; FAR 52.209-11 and DIAR 1452.280-4 must be included in the offeror's Quote. The representations certifications will be categorized as either pass or fail.

M.3 Responsibility Determination

After the evaluation has been completed and the Contracting Officer has decided on whom to award the contract, a responsibility determination will be made of that selected awardee, prior to award. If it is determined that the selected contractor is not responsible, that contractor will be removed from further consideration for award.

M.4 Discussions/Award without Discussions

The Government intends to make award without discussions. The Offeror's initial quote should contain the Offeror's best terms from a pricing and technical standpoint. The Government reserves the right to conduct discussions if the Contracting Officer later determines them to be necessary. Failure to comply with instructions may result in an offer being determined as non-responsive.

As stated above the Government reserves the right to make an award without discussions, except for clarifications as described herein. Any exceptions or deviations by the offeror to the terms and conditions stated in this RFQ for inclusion in the resulting award may make the offer unacceptable for award without discussions. If an offeror proposes exceptions to any of the terms and conditions as stated herein or of the requirements, the Government may make an award, without discussions, to another offeror that did not take exception to the terms and conditions.

Clarifications are limited exchanges with offerors that may occur when award without discussions is contemplated. If award will be made without conducting discussions, offerors may be given the opportunity to clarify certain aspects of their submission or to resolve minor or clerical errors.